

Free Throw
By Rhea Madhogarhia

Characters

Tommy Kid
Father Kid
Elton John
Billy Joel
Pat Ballard
Competition Man

Tommy Kid has signed up for his local rec center's free throw competition. His dad, Father Kid, used to be a big time basketball player, maybe. Tommy aims to surprise and make his father proud today by winning the competition he has spent months practicing for.

Father Kid

Tommy, can I open my eyes?

Tommy Kid

Yeah yeah, here just wait here in the bleachers ok?

Father Kid

Why are we at the rec center? What's going on?

Tommy Kid

Well Dad, I remember you telling me about being the best free throw shooter in the 80's and, well, i've been practicing for months now, I entered a free throw competition.

Father Kid

Why do you have a basketb-

Tommy Kid

Okay Dad just wait here I gotta go check in.

Tommy goes over to competition man

Competition Man

Here to check in, kid?

Tommy

Yup!

Competition Man

Great. I'm just gonna need your name and what you'll be throwing with.

Tommy

Only a little confused

Tommy Kid! You might know my dad? Father Kid. He's over there on the bleachers

Points at father kid, father kid waves.

Competition Man

A little starstruck

Oh woah. You're his kid? Can't wait to see you throw little dude. Your big man free threw some crazy shit back in the day.

Tommy

Haha yeah so I've heard. OH and, I wasn't sure if you guys would have them so I brought my own ball

Competition Man

Chuckling to himself a little

A ball. Mmm okaaaay! I'll put down basketball.

Tommy is still a little confused. Competition man scribbles on his clipboard.

Competition Man

Alright you're the last to check in so just stand to the right (or left) of Elton John.

Tommy

Thanks so much.

Walks over and stands beside Elton John who is standing next to Pat Ballard who is standing next to Billy Joel.

Tommy

Are you actually Elton John? I'm a huge fan. I'm Tommy Kid.

Elton John

Haha yeah. Kid you say? Kid as in Father Kid?

Tommy

You know about my dad? Woah

Elton John

Well yeah hes kinda a legend at these kinds of things.

Tommy

Hm

Competition Man

ALRIGHT EVERYONE THE FREE THROW COMPETITION IS NOW STARTING. FIRST UP
WE'VE GOT BILLY JOEL. HIS ENTERED THROW IS A GRAND PIANO.

Billy Joel

Some do call me the Piano Man.

Billy Joel steps up to the free throw line of the court and chucks a grand piano as far as he can. It goes surprisingly far for a fucking grand piano. The crowd erupts and "Piano Man" starts to play as Billy Joel bows and walks off to the side.

Tommy

To Competition Man

Excuse me?? What just happened? Did he just throw a piano?

Competition Man

What are you talking about Kid? Anyways, next up we have someone named Pat Ballard. And he's chosen... sand? Interesting....and difficult choice!

Pat Ballard

Some do call me Mister Sandman.

Billy Joel

Really dude?

Competition Man

What?

Pat Ballard

Look, I wrote the song okay? I deserve credit where credit is due.

Competition Man

Alright alright. Pat, this is a tricky throw, your standing in this competition could go kaputz if the sand scatters the wrong way.

Pat Ballard

Don't worry I've got this.

Tommy

I'm so confused what the heck is happening right now.

Looks to his dad for explanation

Father Kid seems to be zoned in on Pat Ballrd.

Tommy

Excuse me? Where are the basketballs? Why aren't we shooting free throws? What is this?

Father Kid

Loud whispering

Tommy Kid, shut up this is not the time to be talking.

Tommy looks at his dad bewildered in a way that says "are you serious right now"

Pat Ballard

To himself

I got this.

Billy Joel and Elton John both grip and squeeze Tommy Kid's hand in anticipation for the throw.

Pat throws the sand and it goes... not very far. It falls as soon as it leaves his hand.

The crowd groans.

Competition Man

Big upset here today for Pat. I think a sandball tactic mighta have worked better but what do I know right?

Father Kid

FUCK

Tommy Kid

Dad, what's going on?!?!?!?!?

Father Kid

Junior Kid, show some respect. A man's career has been ruined today. I felt the same thing he did in 89.

Tommy Kid

Almost whimpering

Wha-

Competition Man

Alright everyone we've got a competition regular here. He showed solid performance last season. Let's see if his season debut today will secure his place in the octo-finals.

A rocket is wheeled into the stadium.

Elton John

Some do call me the rocket man.

Tommy Kid

You've gotta be kidding me

Billy Joel

Really man? Really????

Pat Ballard

To Billy Joel

Hey, maybe try supporting your fellow musicians?

Elton ignores Billy and throws the rocket. The crowd roars again except some scream because its a literal rocket.

Competition Man

Amazing throw Elton. The destruction to the rec center will cost you a deduction. BUt another strong performance here today. Big fan. Alright next we've got Tom-

Tommy

EVERYONE STOP. WHAT THE HELL IS HAPPENING HERE. WHY WAS A ROCKET JUST THROWN? HOW DID HE EVEN PICK THAT UP. DAD?????

Father Kid

Son, I tried to tell you earlier but you seemed so eager to participate. I wasn't a free throw shooter. I was champion of the Free Throw.

Competition Man

Yeah kid. This is the Free Throw. Think Freestyle in a swimming competition, but with throwing. You can throw whatever you want. A basketball is a pretty lame choice.

Tommy

Are you serious?

Billy Joel

Yeah Kid, can't believe you didn't know that. Father was the craziest thrower. He once threw a mobile home.

Tommy

Dad?

Father Kid

Tommy. I'm sorry. I know you said you've been practicing for months. Why don't you just show us the free throw anyway??

Competition Man

Yeah little Kid. Go ahead.

Elton John and Billy Joel harmonize while saying " show us what you got"

Tommy steps up to the free throw line. Dribbles the ball a little. He shoots.

He misses.

Black

Works Cited